

Docker Interview Cheat Sheet

What is Docker?

Docker is a containerization platform that packages applications with dependencies to run consistently across environments.

Image vs Container

Image: Read-only blueprint

Container: Running instance with its own state

Dockerfile Basics

FROM, WORKDIR, COPY, RUN, EXPOSE, CMD

Why Docker Build Feels Slow?

Docker builds images in layers. If a layer changes, all following layers rebuild. Optimize by installing dependencies before copying source code.

COPY vs ADD

COPY: Simple and predictable (recommended)

ADD: Can extract tar files and download from URLs (use carefully)

Volumes

Containers are ephemeral. Volumes persist data beyond container lifecycle.

Networking

Containers must be on the same network and communicate using service/container names.

Docker Compose

Used for multi-container applications using a YAML file.

Debugging

docker logs & docker exec are key debugging tools.

Common Commands

docker build, docker run, docker ps, docker images, docker stop, docker rm

Interview Tip

Explain concepts clearly with practical examples.